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Xbox at Gamescom 2013

Engadget previews what Xbox has to offer at this year's Gamescom gaming convention. Read on <http://dgit.in/1d8gHSM>

What makes GIGABYTE tick

To better understand some of the technical wizardry employed on their motherboards and future product plans, we got insights from **Colin Brix, Technical Marketing Director, GIGABYTE**. Excerpts from our interview:

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1 What unique new tech is Gigabyte packing into its 8 series motherboards?

For our 8 series motherboards, we have three main product segments including Gaming, Overclocking and Performance motherboards and we have added quite a few new features for each. For Gaming we are the first motherboard to include an onboard OP-AMP socket as well as Creative Sound Core3D, gold plated audio jacks, Killer + Intel dual LAN and a new water block + fan heatsink design. For our overclocking motherboards, our overclocker HiCookie has added a bunch of new features including GIGABYTE OC Ignition, OC Brace, OC Touch hardware overclocking buttons and gold plating for the power connectors, the PCIe slots, memory slots as well as the CPU socket.

2 With the 8 series motherboards, Gigabyte's introducing UD5 Plus for the first time. What's its significance?

GIGABYTE Ultra Durable 5 Plus debuts on GIGABYTE 8 Series motherboards, with a range of features and component choices that provide record-breaking performance, cool and efficient operation and extended motherboard lifespan. Some of the key Ultra Durable 5 Plus features include

1. Industry-leading PWM controllers and PowIRstage ICs from International Rectifier. These components are 100% digital, offering incredible precision in delivering power of the 4th Generation Intel processors.
2. All New Heat Sink Design offering uncompromisingly efficient cooling on key areas of the motherboard including the PWM area and chipset.
3. GIGABYTE UEFI DualBIOS : GIGABYTE DualBIOS provides a 'Main



Colin Brix, Technical Marketing Director, GIGABYTE

BIOS' and a 'Backup BIOS', making users protected from BIOS failure due to virus attack, hardware malfunction, improper OC settings or power failure during the update process.

4. Ultra USB3+ packs up to 10 USB 3.0 ports per board. Each of these 10 USB 3.0 ports are also provided with a dedicated fuse, ensuring that an unexpected malfunction on one port, will affect only that port, isolating potential damage and protecting other connected devices.

3 In the 8 series of motherboards, Gigabyte seems to have focused a lot of attention on audio implementation. Why is that? Can you also explain the audio tech deployed on your latest Z87 boards in detail? Do you think in a market like India such DIY mobo technology will take off?

We were the first motherboard manufacturer to put Creative's digital Sound Blaster processor on our first G1.Killer motherboards and now you see other companies doing the same. This genera-

tion we had added the Creative Sound Core3D as well as a new feature called GIGABYTE AMP-UP, which as you mentioned, is the world's first motherboard OP-Amp socket, allowing enthusiasts to swap out the motherboard's onboard operational amplifier (Op Amp) using a range of nuanced OP Amps available on the market.

We've already had quite a lot of positive feedback from our Indian customers for this feature, as not only are they able to customize their onboard audio experience for the first time, but it is also a relatively cost effective way to get a huge improvement in sound quality, without having to go out and buy really expensive high-end speakers or cables.

4 Gigabyte's boards are known for durability. Can you give us an insight into some of your testing (or R&D) methodologies that help ensure Gigabyte's motherboards deliver on their promise of durability?

The first step in ensuring the quality of our motherboards is to make sure that we use only the highest quality components for our design. This is especially important for the power delivery to the CPU and that is why every year we add a new Ultra Durable technology to our motherboards. From there, we build several stages of development boards that are rigorously tested for everything from audio quality to mechanical drop tests to see how the board will fare during transportation. We also send our motherboards to certified 3rd party testing companies to make sure our boards comply with all global regulations. Once the boards enter the manufacturing stage, every single board is tested multiple times throughout the manufacturing process to ensure our customers new motherboard will work from the day they open their box, to the day they decide to upgrade it. 